

N.Y. TIMES
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as the basis for movies, lining the mass suicides at town, Guyana; the shoot-at Ruby Ridge, Idaho, and violent confrontation with the Davidian cult near Waco,

in a rental car in St. Louis in November 1973, and the pair routinely paid out on motel bills. They said at first they slept in cars or roadside parks in their car, one day Our Father revealed to a part of the scripture in which said the 'Lord will be as a thief in the night,' Mrs. Walsh wrote in a script she is preparing about three months with the pair. They checked into a motel giving a false name. They took all meals at the motel charging it to their bill, then left very early on the morning of their departure, without pay-

the use of Mrs. Walsh's gasoline card was their undoing. After she left her first husband with a yellow car, he filed a complaint that led to Mr. Applewhite's arrest in November 1974. According to my gas tickets, I was on the West Coast, and then a few days later, they'd be on the East Coast," her first husband, John Morgan, told The Houston Chronicle in 1975. "They may try to tell people they get around some way. But I've got proof they're

traveling intellectually in that direction.

"We are becoming increasingly awkward in this world's structure and giggle a lot at ourselves as two folks from outerspace would as they realize they can't fit the patterns of social practice," reads a November 1973 letter.

"When we converse in our minds (while thinking) we are really listening to the conversations between the alien spirits," reads a letter dated Feb. 27, 1974.

In that letter, the pair already refer to their bodies as "vehicles" or "houses" that must eventually be shed to reach a higher level, a Christian concept that Mr. Applewhite apparently distorted last week when he led his followers into suicide.

These themes recur in an unpublished manuscript that Mr. Applewhite and Ms. Nettles wrote in January 1973, with the title: "I Can't Believe That — But You Must."

"Deaths, marriage, sweethearts, and even newborn babes are elements which keep us from climbing out of the physical," wrote the pair, who later pressed followers to turn their backs on friends, family and fortune.

In a passage that foreshadowed events 25 years later, they wrote: "Man has experienced in space travel the process necessary to leave the earth magnet and arrive at a space which seems to be Nirvana, the absence of a gravity force."

'Belongings

re, books, etc., applicable to outdoor and those adventures and activities, and hundreds of video and tapes." They also found beds, presses, furniture and other personal effects.

said his department would not do the registration of the weapons and held out the possibility that might all be properly licensed. Any event, he said of the cultists, as it relates to their deaths, insignificant," and there is no notice that the weapons were ever "either for hunting or criminal activity."

Initially, Lieutenant Lipscomb investigators retrieved "boxes numerous to mention." He said books and the tapes would be lined over the next few weeks any clues they might provide to reasons for the group's suicide. "We have to look at all that before we can tell if it has any significance or not," he said, "and we're now starting."

The latest discovery came as officials indicated that their investigation was winding down. So far, more than 21 of the 39 cultists, officials said.

U.S. Has Stopped Tracking U.F.O.'s

WASHINGTON, April 1 (AP) — Convinced that there is no extraterrestrial threat, the United States military long ago stopped keeping track of U.F.O.'s, a Pentagon spokesman, Kenneth Bacon, said today.

The suicide last week of 39 members of Heaven's Gate, a high-tech U.F.O. cult, prompted a question at today's Pentagon briefing on whether the military tracked U.F.O.'s.

Mr. Bacon said the Air Force investigated U.F.O. reports from 1947 to 1969. He said it stopped because, out of 12,618 reported sightings, investigators found no evidence of extraterrestrials or even of any aircraft representing exotic technology or a threat to the United States.

Virtually all the U.F.O. reports investigated were explainable as aircraft or weather phenomena, he said.

Asked about the possible existence of U.F.O.'s, Mr. Bacon said the United States Government "cannot substantiate that they exist."

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